

Verified

UEFA Nations League

UEFA introduced the Nations League to replace many international friendlies with competitive league matches. The highest-ranked teams compete for a place in the Nations League Finals.

UEFA Nations League Finals, 2018-19 onward

Season	Finals host	Winner	Runner-up	Third	Fourth	Final	Final date	Story
2024-25	Germany	Portugal	Spain	France	Germany	2-2; Portugal 5-3 pens	8 June 2025	▶ Tap to read the story Portugal beat Spain on penalties in the 2025 final to become the competition's first two-time champion.

Season	Finals host	Winner	Runner-up	Third	Fourth	Final	Final date	Story
<u>2022-23</u>	Netherlands	<u>Spain</u>	Croatia	Italy	Netherlands	0-0; Spain 5-4 pens	18 June 2023	►  Tap to read the story Spain won the 2023 final on penalties after a goalless draw with Croatia.
<u>2020-21</u>	Italy	<u>France</u>	Spain	Italy	Belgium	France 2-1 Spain	10 October 2021	►  Tap to read the story Italy hosted the 2021 Finals without reaching the final itself, finishing third as France beat Spain 2-1 for the title.
<u>2018-19</u>	Portugal	<u>Portugal</u>	Netherlands	England	Switzerland	Portugal 1-0 Netherlands	9 June 2019	►  Tap to read the story Portugal won the first-ever Nations League Finals in 2019, beating Netherlands 1-0 as hosts.

Podium by edition

2024-25 Hosted by Germany 🏆 Portugal 🥈 Spain 🥉 France 4. Germany	2022-23 Hosted by Netherlands 🏆 Spain 🥈 Croatia 🥉 Italy 4. Netherlands	2020-21 Hosted by Italy 🏆 France 🥈 Spain 🥉 Italy 4. Belgium
2018-19 Hosted by Portugal 🏆 Portugal 🥈 Netherlands 🥉 England 4. Switzerland		

🏆 **Champions by titles**

Generated automatically from the edition table above. Totals group a nation with its sporting predecessor only where the source content does (Germany includes West Germany); every other name is counted as written.

Portugal 2018-19, 2024-25	2
France 2020-21	1

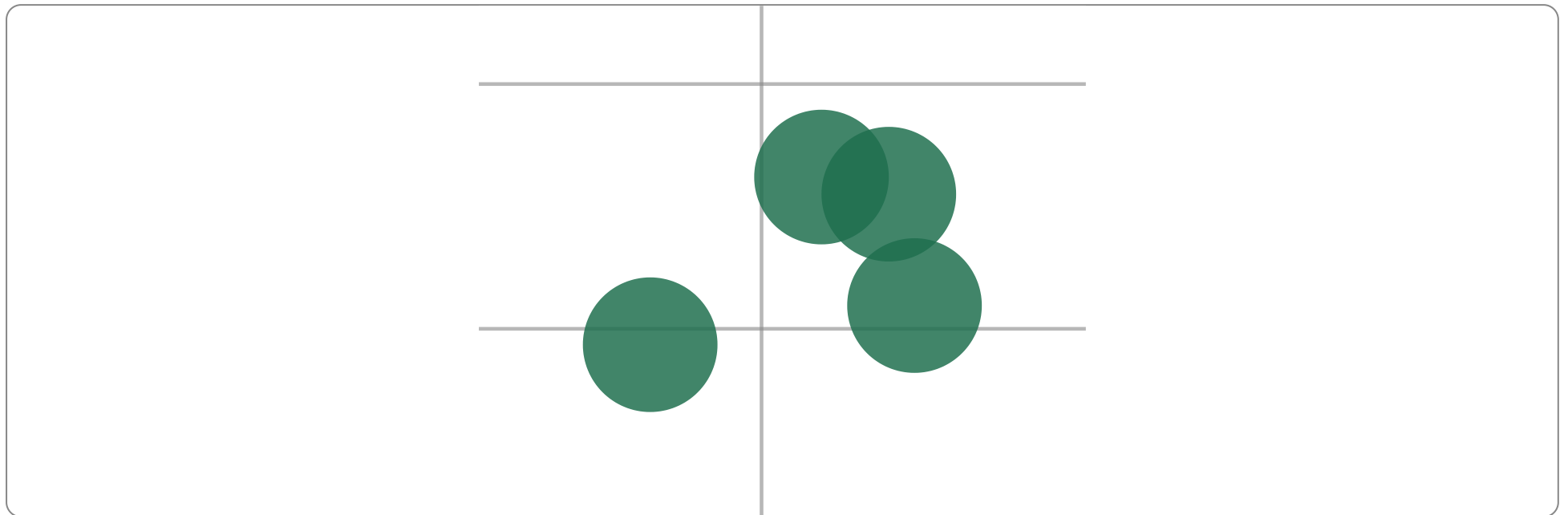
Spain

1

2022-23

Where the tournament has been hosted

Every host country's approximate location on a simple latitude/longitude grid, grouped by region in the list below - not a claim of exact borders, just roughly where in the world each edition took place. Bigger dots hosted more than once.



Europe

Portugal 1 time

2018-19

Italy 1 time

2020-21

Netherlands 1 time

2022-23

Germany 1 time

2024-25

How it works

- Every UEFA national team is placed into one of four leagues (A to D) by strength, then split into small groups within its league.
- Teams play each other in their group; results promote the best teams to a higher league and relegate the weakest to a lower one, alongside separate World Cup/EURO qualifying.
- The four League A group winners advance to the Nations League Finals: two semifinals, a third-place match, and a final, all hosted by one of the four finalists.
- Held every two years.

Key facts

- Portugal won the inaugural edition.
- Portugal became the first two-time champion in 2025.
- Croatia reached its first Nations League final in 2023.
- The competition uses promotion and relegation between leagues.

Player of the Finals winners

- UEFA has named a best-player award at every Nations League Finals since the competition's 2019 launch, initially called "Player of the Tournament" before being renamed "Player of the Finals" from 2021 onward.
- **2019:** Bernardo Silva (Portugal).
- **2021:** Sergio Busquets (Spain).
- **2023:** Rodri (Spain).
- **2025:** Nuno Mendes (Portugal).

Winning managers

- **2019:** Fernando Santos (Portugal).

- **2021:** Didier Deschamps (France).
- **2023:** Luis de la Fuente (Spain) - the same season he took charge of Spain, before also winning EURO 2024 and the 2026 World Cup with them.
- **2025:** Roberto Martínez (Portugal) - his first trophy since taking over from Fernando Santos.



Winning captains

- The captain is the player who lifts the trophy on the podium; every Nations League Finals winner has had one across all four completed editions.
- **2019:** Cristiano Ronaldo (Portugal).
- **2021:** Hugo Lloris (France).
- **2023:** Jordi Alba (Spain) - given the captaincy for the Finals by manager Luis de la Fuente.
- **2025:** Cristiano Ronaldo (Portugal) - the first captain to lift the Nations League trophy twice.



Memorable moments

- Portugal won the first-ever Nations League Finals in 2019, beating Netherlands 1–0 as hosts.
- Italy hosted the 2021 Finals without reaching the final itself, finishing third as France beat Spain 2–1 for the title.
- Spain won the 2023 final on penalties after a goalless draw with Croatia.
- Portugal beat Spain on penalties in the 2025 final to become the competition's first two-time champion.
- The host nation has finished in the Finals' top four in every edition so far, including Germany finishing fourth in 2025.



References & review

Status: verified

Last reviewed: 1 September 2026

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Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.